我家的猫

一只白猫和不要猫的妈妈

Our Cat

A white cat, and a mum who didn't want a cat

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Footnotes mark names and words above HSK 2 (HSK 3.0 lists: github.com/ivankra/hsk30, MIT).

1 我叫乐乐[†]，今年九岁。我家有爸爸、妈妈、哥哥东东[‡]和我。现在，我家还有小白[§]。小白是一只白猫。可是一年以前，妈妈说什么也不要猫。

下雨的晚上

2 那是去年十月的一个晚上，外边下着大雨。我和哥哥快要睡觉了，忽然听见门外有很小的声音，好像一个小孩子在哭。哥哥打开门一看，门口有一只小白猫。它身上都是水，很冷，一直在叫。哥哥说："我没见过这么小的猫。"

3 我说："哥哥，它是不是饿了？"哥哥去拿了一点儿牛奶，小猫很快就喝完了。我们又给了它一点儿鱼，它也吃完了。哥哥说："它一定好几天没吃东西了。"

† 乐乐 *Lèlè* Lele (the narrator)
‡ 东东 *Dōngdōng* Dongdong (Lele's brother)
§ 小白 *Xiǎobái* Xiaobai ("Little White")

My name is Lele, and I'm nine. In my family there are Dad, Mum, my big brother Dongdong and me. Now our family also has Xiaobai. Xiaobai is a white cat. But a year ago, Mum wouldn't hear of having a cat. 1

A Rainy Night

It was an evening last October, and it was raining hard outside. My brother and I were about to go to bed when we suddenly heard a tiny sound outside the door, like a little child crying. My brother opened the door and looked. There was a little white cat at the door. It was soaking wet and very cold, and it wouldn't stop crying. My brother said, "I've never seen such a tiny cat." 2

I said, "Brother, is it hungry?" My brother went and got some milk, and the kitten drank it all up very quickly. Then we gave it a little fish, and it ate that up too. My brother said, "It must not have eaten for days." 3

妈妈不要猫

4 这时候，妈妈来了。她看见小猫，马上说：“不行！我们家不养猫。”“为什么？”我问。“养猫很累。猫要吃饭，要洗澡，还要有人天天跟它玩。你们要上学，爸爸妈妈要上班，谁来照顾它？”

5 哥哥说：“我来照顾它！我天天早上给它吃饭，晚上给它洗澡。”我也说：“我也照顾它！我放学回家就跟它玩。”妈妈看看外边的大雨，说：“好吧，今天晚上它可以住在这儿。明天雨停了，你们就给它找一个新家。”

6 第二天，雨停了，可是我们没有给它找新家。哥哥说：“妈妈，给我们一个星期，好吗？我们一定好好儿照顾它。”妈妈看看我们，又看看小猫，说：“就一个星期。”

Mum Doesn't Want a Cat

Just then Mum came in. When she saw the kitten, she said at once, "No! We're not keeping a cat." "Why?" I asked. "Keeping a cat is hard work. A cat has to be fed and washed, and someone has to play with it every day. You two go to school and Dad and I go to work. Who's going to look after it?" 4

My brother said, "I'll look after it! I'll feed it every morning and wash it every evening." I said too, "I'll look after it too! I'll play with it as soon as I get home from school." Mum looked at the heavy rain outside and said, "All right, it can stay here tonight. When the rain stops tomorrow, you find it a new home." 5

The next day the rain stopped, but we didn't find it a new home. My brother said, "Mum, give us one week, OK? We'll look after it really well, we promise." Mum looked at us, then at the kitten, and said, "One week. That's all." 6

7 我们要给小猫起名字了。哥哥问：“叫它小白[†]还是大白[‡]？”我说：“它这么小，就叫小白吧。”从那天起，小白就住在我们家了。

猫去哪儿了？

8 我们家以前没养过猫，所以有很多问题。小白早上五点就起来了，在我们的床上走来走去，叫我们起来。可是哥哥天天七点才起床。小白吃饭的时候，要吃鱼或者肉，不喜欢吃米饭。小白也不喜欢洗澡。哥哥给它洗澡，它就大声叫。洗完了，哥哥身上的水比小白身上的还多。

9 有一天，小白在桌子上玩，桌子上的杯子掉到地上，坏了。那是妈妈最喜欢的杯子。妈妈看着地上的杯子，半天没说话。我和哥哥都很怕。我想：“这次妈妈要生气了，小白要离开我们家了。”

† 小白 *Xiǎobái* Xiaobai (”Little White”)　　‡ 大白 *Dàbái* Dabai (”Big White”)

Now we had to give the kitten a name. My brother asked, "Shall we call it Xiaobai or Dabai?" I said, "It's so little. Let's call it Xiaobai." From that day on, Xiaobai lived in our home. 7

Where Did the Cat Go?

We had never kept a cat before, so there were lots of problems. Xiaobai was up at five in the morning, walking all over our beds to get us up. But my brother never got up before seven. At mealtimes, Xiaobai wanted fish or meat and didn't like rice. Xiaobai didn't like baths either. Whenever my brother washed it, it yowled loudly. When the bath was over, my brother was wetter than Xiaobai. 8

One day Xiaobai was playing on the table, and a cup fell off onto the floor and broke. It was Mum's favourite cup. Mum looked at the cup on the floor and didn't say anything for a long time. My brother and I were both scared. I thought, "Now Mum is going to be angry, and Xiaobai is going to have to leave." 9

9 可是妈妈只说了一句：“以后杯子别放在桌子上了。”

10 一个星期快要到了。星期六早上，我们起来以后，找不到小白[†]了。家里找了，楼下也找了，哪儿都没有。原来，爸爸早上出去的时候，门没关好。我哭了。哥哥说：“它是不是回自己的家了？”

11 我们找了一个上午，又找了一个下午，问了楼里很多人：“你们看见一只小白猫了吗？它会不会在楼下，或者在别人家里？”天快要黑了，我们还是没有找到它。晚上，我和哥哥都吃不下饭。妈妈说：“别哭了。它是猫，它会回来的。”可是我看见，妈妈也一口饭都没吃。

† 小白 *Xiǎobái* Xiaobai (”Little White”)

But all Mum said was, "From now on, don't leave cups on the table." 9

The week was almost up. On Saturday morning, when we got up, we 10
couldn't find Xiaobai. We looked all over the flat and downstairs, but it was nowhere. It turned out that when Dad went out that morning, he hadn't shut the door properly. I cried. My brother said, "Has it gone back to its own home?"

We searched all morning and then all afternoon, and asked lots of people in 11
the building, "Have you seen a little white cat? Could it be downstairs, or in someone else's home?" It was almost dark, and we still hadn't found it. That evening, neither my brother nor I could eat. Mum said, "Stop crying. It's a cat. It will come back." But I noticed that Mum didn't eat a single bite either.

回来了

12 夜里十一点，我睡不着，起来喝水。我看见门开着，妈妈一个人坐在门口。她拿着一碗鱼，在门外小声叫：“小白[†]，小白……”“妈妈，你在做什么？”妈妈说：“小白饿了就会回家。它闻到鱼，也许就回来了。”

13 我坐在妈妈旁边，跟她一起等。十二点了，一点了，我快要睡了。忽然，楼下有很小的声音。是小白！到了一点多，小白才回来。它身上很脏，可是没事。妈妈马上跑过去，看了看小白，又哭又笑：“你去哪儿了？我们找了你一天！”

14 第二天早上，哥哥小声问妈妈：“妈妈，一个星期到了。我们要给小白找新家吗？还是……”妈妈说：“新家？它是我们家的猫，为什么要给别人？”我和哥哥都笑了。

† 小白 *Xiǎobái* Xiaobai (”Little White”)

Back Home

At eleven that night I couldn't sleep, so I got up for a drink of water. I saw 12
that the door was open and Mum was sitting in the doorway alone. She was holding a bowl of fish and calling softly outside the door, "Xiaobai, Xiaobai..." "Mum, what are you doing?" Mum said, "When Xiaobai is hungry, it'll come home. If it smells the fish, maybe it will come back."

I sat down beside Mum and waited with her. Twelve o'clock came, then one 13
o'clock, and I was nearly asleep. Suddenly there was a tiny sound downstairs. It was Xiaobai! Only after one o'clock did Xiaobai come back. It was very dirty, but it was all right. Mum ran over at once, looked Xiaobai over, and laughed and cried at the same time. "Where have you been? We looked for you all day!"

The next morning, my brother asked Mum quietly, "Mum, the week is up. 14
Do we have to find Xiaobai a new home? Or..." Mum said, "A new home? It's our cat. Why would we give it to anyone?" My brother and I both laughed.

现在，小白[†]比去年大多了。它晚上睡在哪儿？睡在我的床上，还是哥哥的床上？都不是。它最喜欢睡在妈妈的床上。我和哥哥常常说：“我们家最喜欢小白的人，不是我们，是妈妈！”

† 小白 *Xiǎobái* Xiaobai (”Little White”)

Now Xiaobai is much bigger than last year. Where does it sleep at night? On my bed, or on my brother's? Neither. Its favourite place to sleep is Mum's bed. My brother and I often say, "The person in our family who loves Xiaobai most isn't us. It's Mum!"